INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

QA • SQL • API • Python • Playwright • Automation • SDET

100+ PAGE INTERVIEW PREPARATION MASTER GUIDE

UNDERSTAND → PRACTICE → EXPLAIN → CODE → DEBUG → MOCK → IMPROVE → GET HIRED

Designed for QA Engineers, Automation Test Engineers, SDETs, freshers and experienced candidates preparing for technical interviews.

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How to Use This Interview Book

Do not memorize answers word-for-word. Interviewers often change the scenario. Learn the concept, the reasoning and the trade-off.

Answer framework

Definition → **Why** → **Example** → **Implementation** → **Failure/Edge Case** → **Trade-off**

When answering project questions

Use: **Context** → **Problem** → **Your responsibility** → **Approach** → **Difficult issue** → **Debugging** → **Result** → **Lesson**.

Interview preparation levels

Level	Goal	Evidence
Foundation	Explain concepts	Clear verbal answers
Practical	Apply concepts	Hands-on exercises
Engineering	Design/reason	Architecture and trade-offs
Interview	Perform under pressure	Mocks + timed drills

01. QA & Testing Fundamentals

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **QA & Testing Fundamentals**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is software testing?**
2. **Verification vs validation?**
3. **Functional vs non-functional testing?**
4. **Smoke vs sanity vs regression?**
5. **Retesting vs regression?**
6. **Test case vs test scenario?**
7. **What is exploratory testing?**
8. **What is risk-based testing?**
9. **What is test coverage?**
10. **What makes a good test case?**
11. **What is the test pyramid?**
12. **When should testing start?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

01. QA & Testing Fundamentals — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is software testing?	
Verification vs validation?	
Functional vs non-functional testing?	
Smoke vs sanity vs regression?	
Retesting vs regression?	
Test case vs test scenario?	
What is exploratory testing?	
What is risk-based testing?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

01. QA & Testing Fundamentals — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **QA & Testing Fundamentals**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• What is test coverage?

• What makes a good test case?

• What is the test pyramid?

• When should testing start?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

02. SDLC, STLC & Agile

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **SDLC, STLC & Agile**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Explain SDLC.**
2. **Explain STLC.**
3. **What is the role of QA in Agile?**
4. **What happens in a sprint?**
5. **What is shift-left testing?**
6. **What are acceptance criteria?**
7. **Definition of Ready vs Definition of Done?**
8. **How do you test incomplete requirements?**
9. **How do you handle changing requirements?**
10. **How do you estimate testing effort?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

02. SDLC, STLC & Agile — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Explain SDLC.	
Explain STLC.	
What is the role of QA in Agile?	
What happens in a sprint?	
What is shift-left testing?	
What are acceptance criteria?	
Definition of Ready vs Definition of Done?	
How do you test incomplete requirements?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

02. SDLC, STLC & Agile — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **SDLC, STLC & Agile**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• How do you handle changing requirements?

• How do you estimate testing effort?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

03. Test Design & Scenario Questions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Test Design & Scenario Questions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Explain equivalence partitioning.**
2. **Explain boundary value analysis.**
3. **When would you use a decision table?**
4. **How do you test a state-based system?**
5. **How would you test a login page?**
6. **How would you test a payment flow?**
7. **How would you test a country dropdown?**
8. **How would you test OTP?**
9. **How would you test search?**
10. **How would you test file upload?**
11. **How would you test an API rate limit?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

03. Test Design & Scenario Questions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Explain equivalence partitioning.	
Explain boundary value analysis.	
When would you use a decision table?	
How do you test a state-based system?	
How would you test a login page?	
How would you test a payment flow?	
How would you test a country dropdown?	
How would you test OTP?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

03. Test Design & Scenario Questions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Test Design & Scenario Questions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• How would you test search?

• How would you test file upload?

• How would you test an API rate limit?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

04. Defects, Severity, Priority & RCA

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Defects, Severity, Priority & RCA**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is a defect lifecycle?**
2. **Severity vs priority?**
3. **What makes a good bug report?**
4. **What if a developer says the bug is not reproducible?**
5. **What if a critical defect is found before release?**
6. **How do you perform root-cause analysis?**
7. **How do you handle duplicate defects?**
8. **How do you decide whether to reopen a defect?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

04. Defects, Severity, Priority & RCA — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is a defect lifecycle?	
Severity vs priority?	
What makes a good bug report?	
What if a developer says the bug is not reproducible?	
What if a critical defect is found before release?	
How do you perform root-cause analysis?	
How do you handle duplicate defects?	
How do you decide whether to reopen a defect?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

04. Defects, Severity, Priority & RCA — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Defects, Severity, Priority & RCA**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

05. SQL Fundamentals

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **SQL Fundamentals**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **SELECT and WHERE?**
2. **ORDER BY?**
3. **GROUP BY vs HAVING?**
4. **INNER vs LEFT JOIN?**
5. **Subquery vs JOIN?**
6. **What is a CTE?**
7. **What are window functions?**
8. **How do you find duplicates?**
9. **How do you find the second-highest salary?**
10. **How do you find records missing in another table?**
11. **COUNT(*) vs COUNT(column)?**
12. **NULL handling?**

How to answer

> Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

05. SQL Fundamentals — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
SELECT and WHERE?	
ORDER BY?	
GROUP BY vs HAVING?	
INNER vs LEFT JOIN?	
Subquery vs JOIN?	
What is a CTE?	
What are window functions?	
How do you find duplicates?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

05. SQL Fundamentals — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **SQL Fundamentals**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• How do you find the second-highest salary?

• How do you find records missing in another table?

• COUNT(*) vs COUNT(column)?

• NULL handling?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

06. Advanced SQL & Database Testing

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Advanced SQL & Database Testing**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Primary vs foreign key?**
2. **Unique vs not-null constraint?**
3. **Normalization?**
4. **Transactions?**
5. **COMMIT vs ROLLBACK?**
6. **Isolation levels?**
7. **Deadlocks?**
8. **Stored procedure testing?**
9. **Trigger testing?**
10. **Data reconciliation?**
11. **API-to-database validation?**
12. **How do you validate ETL?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

06. Advanced SQL & Database Testing — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Primary vs foreign key?	
Unique vs not-null constraint?	
Normalization?	
Transactions?	
COMMIT vs ROLLBACK?	
Isolation levels?	
Deadlocks?	
Stored procedure testing?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

06. Advanced SQL & Database Testing — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Advanced SQL & Database Testing**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Trigger testing?

• Data reconciliation?

• API-to-database validation?

• How do you validate ETL?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

07. API Testing

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **API Testing**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is REST?**
2. **HTTP methods?**
3. **Status codes?**
4. **Headers vs body?**
5. **Path vs query parameter?**
6. **Authentication vs authorization?**
7. **JWT?**
8. **Idempotency?**
9. **Pagination testing?**
10. **Negative API testing?**
11. **Schema validation?**
12. **How do you chain APIs?**
13. **How do you test rate limiting?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

07. API Testing — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is REST?	
HTTP methods?	
Status codes?	
Headers vs body?	
Path vs query parameter?	
Authentication vs authorization?	
JWT?	
Idempotency?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

07. API Testing — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **API Testing**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Pagination testing?

• Negative API testing?

• Schema validation?

• How do you chain APIs?

• How do you test rate limiting?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

08. API Automation with Python

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **API Automation with Python**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **How would you build an API client?**
2. **requests vs session?**
3. **How do you handle authentication?**
4. **How do you parameterize API tests?**
5. **How do you validate JSON?**
6. **How do you handle retries/timeouts?**
7. **How do you validate API-to-DB?**
8. **How would you organize an API automation framework?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

08. API Automation with Python — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
How would you build an API client?	
requests vs session?	
How do you handle authentication?	
How do you parameterize API tests?	
How do you validate JSON?	
How do you handle retries/timeouts?	
How do you validate API-to-DB?	
How would you organize an API automation framework?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

08. API Automation with Python — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **API Automation with Python**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

09. Python for QA/SDET

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Python for QA/SDET**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **List vs tuple?**
2. **Set vs list?**
3. **Dictionary use cases?**
4. **Mutable vs immutable?**
5. **Functions and arguments?**
6. ***args and **kwargs?**
7. **List comprehensions?**
8. **Lambda?**
9. **Generators?**
10. **Exception handling?**
11. **Classes and inheritance?**
12. **Composition vs inheritance?**
13. **Modules/packages?**
14. **Virtual environments?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

09. Python for QA/SDET — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
List vs tuple?	
Set vs list?	
Dictionary use cases?	
Mutable vs immutable?	
Functions and arguments?	
*args and **kwargs?	
List comprehensions?	
Lambda?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

09. Python for QA/SDET — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Python for QA/SDET**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Generators?

• Exception handling?

• Classes and inheritance?

• Composition vs inheritance?

• Modules/packages?

• Virtual environments?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

10. Python Coding Problems

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Python Coding Problems**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Reverse a string.**
2. **Check palindrome.**
3. **Count character frequency.**
4. **Find duplicates in a list.**
5. **Find missing number.**
6. **Find second-largest value.**
7. **Merge two sorted lists.**
8. **Remove duplicates while preserving order.**
9. **Check anagram.**
10. **Find first non-repeating character.**
11. **Flatten nested list.**
12. **Group records by key.**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

10. Python Coding Problems — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Reverse a string.	
Check palindrome.	
Count character frequency.	
Find duplicates in a list.	
Find missing number.	
Find second-largest value.	
Merge two sorted lists.	
Remove duplicates while preserving order.	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

10. Python Coding Problems — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Python Coding Problems**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Check anagram.

• Find first non-repeating character.

• Flatten nested list.

• Group records by key.

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

11. Object-Oriented Programming for Automation

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Object-Oriented Programming for Automation**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is OOP?**
2. **Class vs object?**
3. **Encapsulation?**
4. **Inheritance?**
5. **Polymorphism?**
6. **Abstraction?**
7. **Interface concept?**
8. **Composition?**
9. **SOLID principles?**
10. **Why does OOP help automation frameworks?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

11. Object-Oriented Programming for Automation — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is OOP?	
Class vs object?	
Encapsulation?	
Inheritance?	
Polymorphism?	
Abstraction?	
Interface concept?	
Composition?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

11. Object-Oriented Programming for Automation — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Object-Oriented Programming for Automation**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• SOLID principles?

• Why does OOP help automation frameworks?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

12. Git & GitHub

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Git & GitHub**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **git clone/status/add/commit?**
2. **Branching strategy?**
3. **Merge vs rebase?**
4. **How do you resolve conflicts?**
5. **What is a pull request?**
6. **Cherry-pick?**
7. **Reset vs revert?**
8. **How do you recover a bad commit?**
9. **What makes a good automation PR?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

12. Git & GitHub — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
git clone/status/add/commit?	
Branching strategy?	
Merge vs rebase?	
How do you resolve conflicts?	
What is a pull request?	
Cherry-pick?	
Reset vs revert?	
How do you recover a bad commit?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

12. Git & GitHub — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Git & GitHub**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• What makes a good automation PR?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

13. Selenium Interview Questions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Selenium Interview Questions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is Selenium WebDriver?**
2. **Locator strategies?**
3. **XPath?**
4. **CSS selectors?**
5. **Implicit vs explicit wait?**
6. **Why avoid sleep?**
7. **Stale element?**
8. **Frames?**
9. **Windows/tabs?**
10. **Alerts?**
11. **File upload?**
12. **Page Object Model?**
13. **Selenium Grid?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

13. Selenium Interview Questions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is Selenium WebDriver?	
Locator strategies?	
XPath?	
CSS selectors?	
Implicit vs explicit wait?	
Why avoid sleep?	
Stale element?	
Frames?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

13. Selenium Interview Questions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Selenium Interview Questions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Windows/tabs?

• Alerts?

• File upload?

• Page Object Model?

• Selenium Grid?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

14. Playwright Interview Questions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Playwright Interview Questions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Why Playwright?**
2. **Locator strategy?**
3. **Auto-waiting?**
4. **Browser vs context vs page?**
5. **Fixtures?**
6. **Storage state?**
7. **Trace viewer?**
8. **Network interception?**
9. **APIRequest?**
10. **Parallelism?**
11. **Retries?**
12. **Screenshots/video?**
13. **Cross-browser testing?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

14. Playwright Interview Questions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Why Playwright?	
Locator strategy?	
Auto-waiting?	
Browser vs context vs page?	
Fixtures?	
Storage state?	
Trace viewer?	
Network interception?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

14. Playwright Interview Questions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Playwright Interview Questions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• APIRequest?

• Parallelism?

• Retries?

• Screenshots/video?

• Cross-browser testing?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

15. PyTest Interview Questions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **PyTest Interview Questions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is a fixture?**
2. **Fixture scopes?**
3. **Parametrize?**
4. **Markers?**
5. **conftest.py?**
6. **Hooks?**
7. **skip/xfail?**
8. **pytest-xdist?**
9. **How do you share configuration?**
10. **How do you handle retries?**
11. **How do you produce reports?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

15. PyTest Interview Questions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is a fixture?	
Fixture scopes?	
Parametrize?	
Markers?	
conftest.py?	
Hooks?	
skip/xfail?	
pytest-xdist?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

15. PyTest Interview Questions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **PyTest Interview Questions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• How do you share configuration?

• How do you handle retries?

• How do you produce reports?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

16. Automation Framework Architecture

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Automation Framework Architecture**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Script vs framework?**
2. **How would you structure a framework?**
3. **POM vs workflow layer?**
4. **Component objects?**
5. **API client layer?**
6. **Configuration strategy?**
7. **Test data strategy?**
8. **Factory pattern?**
9. **Builder pattern?**
10. **How do you avoid over-engineering?**
11. **How do you make framework maintainable?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

16. Automation Framework Architecture — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Script vs framework?	
How would you structure a framework?	
POM vs workflow layer?	
Component objects?	
API client layer?	
Configuration strategy?	
Test data strategy?	
Factory pattern?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

16. Automation Framework Architecture — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Automation Framework Architecture**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Builder pattern?

• How do you avoid over-engineering?

• How do you make framework maintainable?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

17. Automation Debugging & Flaky Tests

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Automation Debugging & Flaky Tests**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What causes flaky tests?**
2. **How do you classify failures?**
3. **Why not retry everything?**
4. **How do you debug timing failures?**
5. **How do you handle test-data collisions?**
6. **How do you debug CI-only failures?**
7. **What evidence should a failed test produce?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

17. Automation Debugging & Flaky Tests — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What causes flaky tests?	
How do you classify failures?	
Why not retry everything?	
How do you debug timing failures?	
How do you handle test-data collisions?	
How do you debug CI-only failures?	
What evidence should a failed test produce?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

17. Automation Debugging & Flaky Tests — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Automation Debugging & Flaky Tests**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

18. CI/CD, Jenkins & GitHub Actions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **CI/CD, Jenkins & GitHub Actions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is CI/CD?**
2. **Pipeline stages?**
3. **Jenkinsfile?**
4. **PR quality gate?**
5. **Smoke vs regression pipeline?**
6. **Parallel tests?**
7. **Artifacts?**
8. **Secrets?**
9. **How do you diagnose a failed pipeline?**
10. **How do you keep pipelines fast?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

18. CI/CD, Jenkins & GitHub Actions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is CI/CD?	
Pipeline stages?	
Jenkinsfile?	
PR quality gate?	
Smoke vs regression pipeline?	
Parallel tests?	
Artifacts?	
Secrets?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

18. CI/CD, Jenkins & GitHub Actions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **CI/CD, Jenkins & GitHub Actions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• How do you diagnose a failed pipeline?

• How do you keep pipelines fast?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

19. Docker for QA/SDET

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Docker for QA/SDET**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What is Docker?**
2. **Image vs container?**
3. **Dockerfile?**
4. **Compose?**
5. **Volume?**
6. **Network?**
7. **Why containerize tests?**
8. **How do you debug a failed container test?**
9. **Docker in CI?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

19. Docker for QA/SDET — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What is Docker?	
Image vs container?	
Dockerfile?	
Compose?	
Volume?	
Network?	
Why containerize tests?	
How do you debug a failed container test?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

19. Docker for QA/SDET — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Docker for QA/SDET**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Docker in CI?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

20. Performance Testing

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Performance Testing**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Load vs stress vs spike vs endurance?**
2. **Throughput?**
3. **Latency?**
4. **p95/p99?**
5. **Workload model?**
6. **Correlation?**
7. **Parameterization?**
8. **Bottleneck analysis?**
9. **JMeter components?**
10. **How do you interpret a performance report?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

20. Performance Testing — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Load vs stress vs spike vs endurance?	
Throughput?	
Latency?	
p95/p99?	
Workload model?	
Correlation?	
Parameterization?	
Bottleneck analysis?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

20. Performance Testing — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Performance Testing**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• JMeter components?

• How do you interpret a performance report?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

21. Security Testing

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Security Testing**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Authentication vs authorization?**
2. **RBAC?**
3. **IDOR/object-level authorization?**
4. **SQL injection awareness?**
5. **XSS?**
6. **CSRF?**
7. **CORS?**
8. **JWT risks?**
9. **Rate limiting?**
10. **Security headers?**
11. **Secrets management?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

21. Security Testing — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Authentication vs authorization?	
RBAC?	
IDOR/object-level authorization?	
SQL injection awareness?	
XSS?	
CSRF?	
CORS?	
JWT risks?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

21. Security Testing — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Security Testing**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Rate limiting?

• Security headers?

• Secrets management?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

22. Mobile Testing & Appium

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Mobile Testing & Appium**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Native vs hybrid vs mobile web?**
2. **Appium architecture?**
3. **APK/AAB?**
4. **Emulator vs real device?**
5. **ADB?**
6. **Permissions?**
7. **WebView?**
8. **Device fragmentation?**
9. **Network testing?**
10. **Crash/ANR?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

22. Mobile Testing & Appium — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Native vs hybrid vs mobile web?	
Appium architecture?	
APK/AAB?	
Emulator vs real device?	
ADB?	
Permissions?	
WebView?	
Device fragmentation?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

22. Mobile Testing & Appium — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Mobile Testing & Appium**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Network testing?

• Crash/ANR?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

23. Cloud Testing

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Cloud Testing**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **What does QA need to know about cloud?**
2. **IAM?**
3. **VPC/networking?**
4. **Security groups?**
5. **Load balancer?**
6. **Cloud logs?**
7. **Auto-scaling?**
8. **Cloud test environment strategy?**
9. **Cost-aware testing?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

23. Cloud Testing — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
What does QA need to know about cloud?	
IAM?	
VPC/networking?	
Security groups?	
Load balancer?	
Cloud logs?	
Auto-scaling?	
Cloud test environment strategy?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

23. Cloud Testing — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Cloud Testing**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Cost-aware testing?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

24. Observability & Production QA

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Observability & Production QA**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Logs vs metrics vs traces?**
2. **Correlation ID?**
3. **p95/p99?**
4. **SLI/SLO/SLA?**
5. **Synthetic monitoring?**
6. **Canary testing?**
7. **Production smoke?**
8. **How do you investigate an incident?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

24. Observability & Production QA — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Logs vs metrics vs traces?	
Correlation ID?	
p95/p99?	
SLI/SLO/SLA?	
Synthetic monitoring?	
Canary testing?	
Production smoke?	
How do you investigate an incident?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

24. Observability & Production QA — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Observability & Production QA**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

25. AI/LLM Testing

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **AI/LLM Testing**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Why is LLM testing different?**
2. **Hallucination?**
3. **Groundedness?**
4. **RAG?**
5. **Retrieval evaluation?**
6. **Golden dataset?**
7. **LLM-as-judge?**
8. **Prompt injection?**
9. **Safety testing?**
10. **Model/prompt regression?**

How to answer

> Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

25. AI/LLM Testing — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Why is LLM testing different?	
Hallucination?	
Groundedness?	
RAG?	
Retrieval evaluation?	
Golden dataset?	
LLM-as-judge?	
Prompt injection?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

25. AI/LLM Testing — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **AI/LLM Testing**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

• Safety testing?

• Model/prompt regression?

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

26. Scenario-Based SDET Questions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Scenario-Based SDET Questions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **How would you test a checkout system?**
2. **How would you automate a distributed workflow?**
3. **How would you test eventual consistency?**
4. **How would you test a system with no UI?**
5. **How would you handle an unstable environment?**
6. **How would you reduce a 3-hour regression suite?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

26. Scenario-Based SDET Questions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
How would you test a checkout system?	
How would you automate a distributed workflow?	
How would you test eventual consistency?	
How would you test a system with no UI?	
How would you handle an unstable environment?	
How would you reduce a 3-hour regression suite?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

26. Scenario-Based SDET Questions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Scenario-Based SDET Questions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

27. Framework Design Scenarios

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Framework Design Scenarios**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Design a scalable Playwright framework.**
2. **Design an API automation framework.**
3. **How would you support multiple environments?**
4. **How would you isolate test data?**
5. **How would you add parallel execution?**
6. **How would you implement reporting and diagnostics?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

27. Framework Design Scenarios — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Design a scalable Playwright framework.	
Design an API automation framework.	
How would you support multiple environments?	
How would you isolate test data?	
How would you add parallel execution?	
How would you implement reporting and diagnostics?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

27. Framework Design Scenarios — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Framework Design Scenarios**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

28. Project & Experience Questions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Project & Experience Questions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Explain your project.**
2. **What was your role?**
3. **What did you automate?**
4. **What was the hardest defect?**
5. **How did you improve coverage?**
6. **How did you handle flaky tests?**
7. **What did you contribute to CI/CD?**
8. **What would you redesign today?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

28. Project & Experience Questions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Explain your project.	
What was your role?	
What did you automate?	
What was the hardest defect?	
How did you improve coverage?	
How did you handle flaky tests?	
What did you contribute to CI/CD?	
What would you redesign today?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

28. Project & Experience Questions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Project & Experience Questions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

29. Senior SDET & Engineering Questions

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **Senior SDET & Engineering Questions**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **How do you define quality?**
2. **How do you choose automation priorities?**
3. **What metrics matter?**
4. **How do you push back on a risky release?**
5. **How do you mentor junior engineers?**
6. **How do you evaluate a framework?**
7. **How do you manage technical debt?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

29. Senior SDET & Engineering Questions — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
How do you define quality?	
How do you choose automation priorities?	
What metrics matter?	
How do you push back on a risky release?	
How do you mentor junior engineers?	
How do you evaluate a framework?	
How do you manage technical debt?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

29. Senior SDET & Engineering Questions — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **Senior SDET & Engineering Questions**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

30. HR, Behavioral & Communication

This chapter contains a focused question bank for **HR, Behavioral & Communication**. Prepare understanding first, then practice answering aloud.

Question bank

1. **Tell me about yourself.**
2. **Why QA/SDET?**
3. **Why are you changing jobs?**
4. **Tell me about a conflict.**
5. **Tell me about a failure.**
6. **How do you handle pressure?**
7. **Why should we hire you?**
8. **Where do you see yourself in three years?**

How to answer

Definition → reasoning → practical example → implementation → edge case → trade-off

30. HR, Behavioral & Communication — Answer Workbook

Write your own answer. Avoid copying a memorized paragraph. Your answer should sound like something you can defend from real experience.

Question	Your answer / key points
Tell me about yourself.	
Why QA/SDET?	
Why are you changing jobs?	
Tell me about a conflict.	
Tell me about a failure.	
How do you handle pressure?	
Why should we hire you?	
Where do you see yourself in three years?	

Self-check

■ Can I answer without notes?

■ Can I give a real example?

■ Can I explain an edge case?

■ Can I describe how I would debug it?

■ Can I explain a trade-off?

30. HR, Behavioral & Communication — Scenario & Mock Interview

Scenario

You are interviewing for a QA/SDET role and the interviewer gives you an unfamiliar problem involving **HR, Behavioral & Communication**. They are evaluating your reasoning more than memorization.

→ Clarify the requirement.

→ State the assumptions.

→ Identify the highest risks.

→ Design the smallest useful test approach.

→ Explain what you would automate.

→ Explain failure diagnostics.

→ Discuss trade-offs and limitations.

Rapid-fire round

Score

Dimension	1	2	3	4	5
Knowledge	■	■	■	■	■
Practical reasoning	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■
Debugging	■	■	■	■	■

Top 100 Questions You Should Be Able to Answer

Testing fundamentals, SQL, API, Python, Playwright, automation, Git, CI/CD and framework architecture.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

SQL Interview Drill Sheet

Joins, grouping, subqueries, CTEs, windows, duplicates, gaps, ranking and data validation.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

API Interview Drill Sheet

HTTP, auth, schema, negative testing, idempotency, pagination, rate limits, chaining and DB validation.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Python Coding Drill Sheet

Strings, arrays, dictionaries, sets, functions, OOP, exceptions, generators and practical test utilities.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Playwright Drill Sheet

Locators, auto-waiting, contexts, fixtures, tracing, storage state, API integration and parallelism.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Automation Framework Design Drill

Layers, POM, workflows, clients, fixtures, data, configuration, reporting and CI.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Debugging Interview Drill

> Reproduce → evidence → isolate → root cause → fix → prevention.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Flaky Test Interview Drill

Classification, synchronization, data isolation, environment issues, retries and reliability metrics.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

CI/CD Interview Drill

Pipelines, gates, artifacts, secrets, parallelism, failure analysis and speed.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Senior SDET Design Round

Quality strategy, risk, architecture, observability, metrics, technical debt and release decisions.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Project Explanation Workbook

> Context → role → architecture → automation → difficult problem → defect → result → lesson.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Mock Interview 1 — Fresher QA

20-question timed mock with score sheet.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Mock Interview 2 — Automation QA

25-question timed mock with score sheet.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Mock Interview 3 — SDET

30-question technical/design mock.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Mock Interview 4 — Senior SDET

Architecture, debugging, leadership and trade-off questions.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

30-Day Interview Preparation Plan

Daily topic rotation, coding, SQL, API, automation and mocks.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

7-Day Before Interview Plan

Revision, project deep dive, company research, questions and confidence checklist.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Interview Day Checklist

Resume, project, environment, communication and closing questions.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Post-Interview Analysis Sheet

Questions asked, weak answers, missing concepts and next actions.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Final Interview Strategy

> Understand → practice → explain → simulate → analyze → improve.

Preparation worksheet

Area	Notes
Key concepts	
Questions to practice	
Hands-on proof	
Weak area	
Next action	

Scoring

Area	1	2	3	4	5
Concepts	■	■	■	■	■
Coding	■	■	■	■	■
Testing	■	■	■	■	■
Automation	■	■	■	■	■
Communication	■	■	■	■	■

Final Interview Readiness Checklist

■ I can explain core testing concepts without memorized definitions.

■ I can write and explain SQL queries.

■ I can test and automate APIs.

■ I can solve basic programming problems.

■ I can explain Playwright/Selenium synchronization and architecture.

■ I can explain my automation framework.

■ I can debug a failed test systematically.

■ I understand Git and CI/CD.

■ I can explain one project deeply.

■ I can discuss trade-offs like a quality engineer.

■ I have completed at least three mock interviews.

■ I can clearly explain my role and measurable contribution.

THE INTERVIEW GOAL: Do not try to sound like someone who knows every tool. Sound like an engineer who understands quality, can learn quickly, can debug problems and can explain decisions.

Abhishek Kamal — QA Automation | SDET Career Guidance

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